

Query Letter Template

One page that earns a request for pages. Draft each zone, then assemble.

01 Greeting Their real name, spelled right. Never "Dear Agent".

Example: Dear Ms. [agent's surname],

02 Hook paragraph Your premise under pressure, in 2 to 3 sentences.

Example: When a burned-out lighthouse keeper finds a message that predicts the next storm, she must choose between saving her town and exposing the secret that ruined her family. She has three days, and the sea is already rising.

03 Book facts Title, genre, word count, two comps.

Example: THE LAST LIGHT is a 92,000 word book club novel that will appeal to readers of [recent comp title] and [recent comp title].

04 Bio paragraph Two lines. Only what is relevant to the book.

Example: I worked ten years as a coast guard dispatcher, which shaped this story. This is my first novel.

05 Closing Brief, professional, no begging.

Example: Thank you for your time and consideration.

FIVE QUICK RULES

- 1 Personalize.** One line showing why this agent, this book.
- 2 One page, always.** Length is the first test you can fail.
- 3 No apologies.** Never "I know you are busy" or "this is my first attempt".
- 4 Comps under 5 years old.** Recent comps prove you know the current market.
- 5 Follow their guidelines.** Exactly. Each agency's rules beat every template, including this one.